BUY, SELL, GIVE, RECEIVE

BetterBarter

A one-stop platform for verified Columbia community members to **buy, sell, give and receive** — from people nearby.

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PROBLEM

Students already trade with each other. Badly.

Fragmented Channels

No dedicated one-stop platform for Columbia community members to buy or sell new or secondhand items. Most search or list across Facebook Marketplace, WhatsApp group chats, eBay, or thrift stores.

Poor Timing & Fit

Buyers may find a cheap item online, only to see pickup is out of reach. Sellers reach a general audience, with no way to find Columbia members nearby.

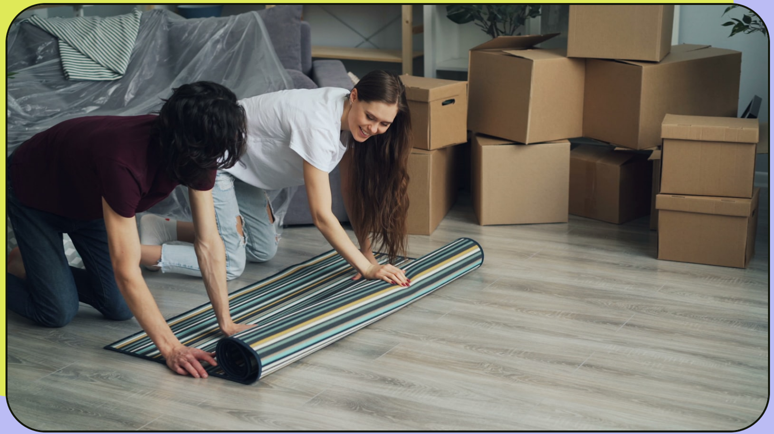
No Trust or Verification

For most online transactions, Columbia community members agree to buy or sell to an unverified stranger, sometimes having to reveal their own personal details.

Waste, Waste, Waste

Buyers may end up paying more for what other Columbia community members may be selling at a cheaper rate. Sellers donate or discard what they cannot sell on time.

A board that only your campus can see.



Columbia-Only Community

Buy, sell, give, or receive items exclusively from verified Columbia community members. Filter by distance and choose to transact with people who live near you.

Built-in Safety

Chat with other members using only your first name — no phone numbers, no emails, no personal information exchanged. Meet up on or near campus, whatever is safe and convenient for you.

Variety & Relevance

Access new or used items from textbooks and furniture to fashion and baby toys, all from people nearby. We are more alike than we think.

PRODUCT DEMO · LIVE TODAY

Deployed, hardened, and open source.

List it in two steps

Up to three photos, then the details. Category, condition, size, how you are listing it, and where you want to meet — from a list of real campus places, never a room.

Claim and chat

Claiming opens a thread and holds the item for three hours, so two people are not walking to the same lobby. Contact details are refused at the point of sending.

Confirm in person

Six digits split across the two phones — three each. Joining them completes the handoff for both sides at once, and is the only thing that counts a reuse event.

0
Contact details exchanged
enforced, not requested

3h
Hold on a claim

7d
Freshness check
stale listings pause themselves

1
Campus per board
enforced in Postgres

Free to students, on every item, always.

Transaction Fee (Later On)

No transaction fees for items, but 1–5% once we evolve to include services categories e.g., tutoring, babysitting, moving help.

Boosted Listings

Sellers pay a small, affordable flat fee to bump their listing to top.

Advertisement Fees

Local businesses (cafes, bookstores, bars, clinics, etc) pay to reach a hyper-targeted, verified Columbia audience.

Institutional Partnerships

Work with institutions to coordinate donation drives.

Campus licence · $15k a year

where the money is

The partnership above, priced. Anchored on a cost the university already carries — move-out hauling, plus the circularity reporting it has to produce anyway — and it buys object-level, auditable reuse data no collection programme can produce. Every projection in this deck is built on this line alone.

Two ways of counting, both from published figures.

	LICENCE REVENUE	OBJECTS MOVED	DERIVATION
TAM	≈$58M / yr	≈46M / yr	3,896 US degree-granting institutions (NCES) × $15k · 15.4M undergraduates × 3 objects
SAM	≈$18M / yr	≈14M / yr	~1,200 residential four-year campuses where move-out density makes it work
SOM · year 3	**≈$375k / yr**	**≈300,000**	**25 licensed campuses — roughly 2% of the serviceable set**

Target Audience: anyone with an active @Columbia.edu.

Industry growth: universities are under binding waste-reduction targets — Columbia's Plan 2030 among them — and have no object-level data to report against them.

NCES IPEDS 2022–23

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

Everyone else is either open to the world, or a bin.

COMPETITOR	WHAT IT IS	WEAKNESS
Facebook Marketplace	Open marketplace, city-wide	Unverified strangers, phone numbers exchanged, travel across the city
WhatsApp / GroupMe	Class and hall group chats	No search, no history, no reputation — a listing scrolls away in an hour
Give + Go Green	Staffed campus collection at check-out	Catches what is left at the end; nothing moves student-to-student before the pile forms
Depop / Vinted	Peer resale, shipped	Packaging and postage on a $10 desk lamp — the emissions cancel the point
BetterBarter	One verified campus, meet in a lobby	Complementary to collection, and the only one producing auditable reuse data

The moat is not the board — a board is a weekend. It is the verified graph plus a confirmation a single person cannot fake.

Distribution runs through institutions, not advertising.

Digital Marketing

Orientation and move-out are the two weeks a campus reuse board sells itself. Class GroupMes, hall floors and EcoReps mailing lists reach the whole intake for nothing — a board is only worth opening where a thousand rooms are being filled or emptied at once.

Strategic Partnerships

Housing, sustainability offices and EcoReps already own both moments and already have the lists. One pilot with data a sustainability office can put in a report becomes the sales collateral for every campus after it.

Phased Rollout

Columbia first, then campuses that open themselves: a university email domain maps to a campus server-side from a registry of 7,328 academic domains, so a new school's board exists the moment its first student signs in.

Self-serve campus creation is built and live

Small numbers, and the assumptions printed next to them.

YEAR	LICENSED CAMPUSES	REVENUE	WHAT HAS TO BE TRUE
1	1 pilot, unpaid	$0	A Columbia pilot runs through the 2027 move-out and produces a defensible number
2	5	$75k	That report converts four more campuses in the same conference
3	**25**	**$375k**	~2% of the 1,200 serviceable campuses, at $15k each

Funding needs

Not capital yet. A pilot campus, an introduction to a housing or sustainability office, and people willing to attack the assumptions in the impact model.

What it costs to run today

Effectively nothing — a free-tier database and static hosting. The first real costs are daily backups and a support inbox, and both arrive with the first pilot.

Boosted listings, placements and service fees are excluded from every figure above

thank you

Let's build the future together.

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